

that you (or your research) didn't come up with.

In addition, I believe in delegation, and the fact that time is money. You defer your legal matters to your lawyer, and tax matters to your accountant. You defer your medical matters to your doctor. You don't perform surgery based on an Internet program's recommendation, do you? And if you are still asking why you can't just do it on your own, please refer to point 5 again. I've yet to find a financial planning program that is intuitive enough to do all that.

Your time outside of work is better spent enjoying life, spending time with your family, and chasing down dreams—not toiling over your finances in a haphazard way. — **Nora Dunn**

9 Signs You Need to Fire Your Financial Planner

In tough economic times, financial planners are on the front lines. They are the gateway to investment returns when the markets are good,

and are the buffer against financial disaster when the markets are bad.

When I was in the financial planning business and markets experienced corrections of sorts, my colleagues and I would brace ourselves for something called “statement shock.” Clients would receive and open their quarterly or monthly statements, and regardless of whether they were keeping up with the news of market performance and understood the circumstances, they would experience a certain degree of shock when they realized how their own dollars and cents were affected.

There were three possible outcomes from this onset of statement shock:

- 1) They would realize that it is a function of the markets and not the planner and stay the course.
- 2) They would call their financial planner for some reassuring words of encouragement and possibly ask for a meeting to devise a new action plan.
- 3) They would look for a new financial planner.

I was lucky. Most of my clients fell into categories one and two. I worked hard to educate them, work within their tolerances for risk, and was there to hold their hands when they needed it. This also usually put me on the receiving end of new clients who were